Festival Town: four-week school pilot plan and skills check

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The pilot in brief

One class plays Festival Town three times a week for four weeks, free of charge, and the teacher runs the same 10-item skills check before and after.

- **Who:** one class from Nursery 2, Primary 1 or Primary 2, any size.
- **How long:** four teaching weeks, plus a week before for the first check and a week after for the second.
- **How much play:** three 20-minute sessions a week, 12 sessions in all, using the classroom TV and remote or a laptop and projector.
- **What it costs:** nothing. No contract, no payment details.
- **What the school gets:** a short report with the class's before and after results, teacher feedback, and a decision point on the licence.

The results show change in one class. With no comparison class they are not proof that the game caused the change. Schools that want a firmer answer can run the check in a second class that does not play (see the report section).

Week by week

The pilot runs six weeks end to end: a setup week, four weeks of play, and a closing week.

Week	What happens	School	MotionPlay Labs
0	Setup call (30 min), screen test in the classroom, letter to parents, first skills check	Picks the class and teacher; sends the letter; teacher runs the check (about 5 minutes per pupil)	Runs the call, checks the screen and sound, sends the letter template and check materials
1	Market Street and Grandma's Farm	Three 20-minute sessions	Mid-week message to the teacher
2	Computer Village and Builders' Yard	Three sessions	Mid-week message

Week	What happens	School	MotionPlay Labs
3	Adire Workshop, then the teacher's choice of place	Three sessions	15-minute check-in call
4	Replay the places the class found hardest	Three sessions	Mid-week message
5	Second skills check, teacher feedback form, review meeting	Teacher runs the check; head attends the review	Writes the report; presents it at the review

Sessions follow the routine in the curriculum map: a short warm-up, about 10 minutes of play with a rotating remote captain, then hands-on work with real objects.

What each side provides

The school provides	MotionPlay Labs provides
One class and its teacher for six weeks	Full access to Festival Town for the class during the pilot, every activity, on the school's devices
A TV with a remote, or a laptop with a projector, and working sound	Setup call and a screen test before the first session
Three 20-minute slots a week in the timetable	Curriculum map, session routine and the Market Street sample lesson
Bottle tops or seeds, a cup of water, a stone and a cork for the skills check	The skills check script, picture cards and record sheet, ready to print
A named contact and a 30-minute review meeting in week 5	Weekly support by message and the end-of-pilot report

Internet is needed the first time each place is opened. After that the browser game plays that place again without data.

The skills check

Ten items, two for each place, scored 0, 1 or 2, so each pupil gets a score out of 20. The teacher runs it one to one in about 5 minutes per pupil, before and after, with the same words and the same objects.

Rules for the teacher: read each question as written; you may repeat it once; give no hints and do not teach during the check; praise effort, not answers.

#	Place	Teacher says and does	Materials	2 points	1 point
1	Market Street	Lays 8 bottle tops in a row: “Count these. How many?”	8 bottle tops	Touches each once and says 8	Says 8 after a recount
2	Market Street	“Here are 5. I add 3 more. How many altogether?”	8 bottle tops	Says 8 by counting on from 5	Says 8 by counting all from 1
3	Market Street	Gives 6 tops and 2 plates: “Share them so both plates have the same.”	6 tops, 2 paper plates	3 and 3, says they are the same	Equal after one try is undone
4	Grandma's Farm	Shows the droopy plant card: “This plant is droopy. What does it need?”	Droopy plant card	Names water and sunlight	Names one of them
5	Grandma's Farm	Shuffles egg, chick and hen cards: “Put them in order, first to last.”	3 life cycle cards	Egg, chick, hen	One pair swapped
6	Grandma's Farm	“Which of these are living?”	Goat, stone, tree, chair cards	All four sorted right	Three sorted right
7	Computer Village	Shows the robot path card: “Put the arrows in order to get the robot to the battery.”	Path card, arrow cards	Right arrows, right order	Right arrows, wrong order
8	Computer Village	Lays a wrong arrow line: “The robot went the wrong way. Which arrow is wrong?”	Path card, arrow cards	Finds the arrow and swaps it	Finds the arrow only
9	Builders' Yard	“Will this float or sink?” for a stone, then a cork. Pupil drops each in.	Cup of water, stone, cork	Both predictions right	One prediction right
10	Adire Workshop	Shows circle, star, circle, star, blank, blank: “Draw what comes next.”	Pattern strip, pencil	Both blanks right	One blank right

Any other answer scores 0. MotionPlay Labs supplies the picture cards and the path card as a printable sheet.

Record sheet and report

The teacher keeps one row per pupil, by code, not name. Only the codes and scores leave the school.

Pupil code	Before (out of 20)	After (out of 20)	Change	Sessions attended (of 12)	Notes
P1-01					
P1-02					
P1-03					

Teacher feedback (week 5), each scored 1 to 5 with a comment:

1. How keen were pupils to play?
2. How easy was it to run on the classroom screen?
3. How well did it fit what you were teaching this term?
4. Did pupils who struggle in class take part more, less or the same?
5. Would you use it next term?

The end-of-pilot report gives:

- The class average score before and after, and the change.
- How many pupils improved, stayed the same or dropped.
- The items with the biggest and smallest gains.
- Sessions run against the 12 planned.
- The teacher's ratings and comments.
- A recommendation on the licence for the next term.

Optional comparison class: a second class at the same level takes both checks but does not play. If the playing class gains more, the case that the game helped is stronger.

Parents, consent and children's data

The pilot collects no personal data from children. Festival Town has no child accounts and no adverts, and the skills check stays on paper in the school.

- **Parents are told in writing before week 1.** The school sends the letter below; a parent can ask for their child to do a different activity during sessions.
- **Scores leave the school only as codes** (P1-01, P1-02). Names stay with the teacher.
- **The school owns its results.** MotionPlay Labs uses them only for the report and, if the school agrees in writing, as anonymous class-level figures in its own materials.

- **Data protection:** handling follows the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023. Paper records are kept by the school and destroyed or archived under its own policy.

Letter to parents (template)

> Dear parent or guardian,
>
> From [start date], [class name] will try Festival Town, a learning game for ages 4 to 7, three times a week for four weeks. Children help a Nigerian town get ready for a festival by counting, growing, coding, building and making. The game is played on the classroom screen. It has no adverts and does not ask for any information about your child.
>
> Before and after the four weeks, your child's teacher will check a few counting, science and pattern skills using everyday objects. Results are kept by the school and shared only as anonymous class figures.
>
> If you have questions, or would rather your child did a different activity during these sessions, please speak to [teacher name].
>
> [Head teacher name], [School name]